BREAKING THE INFORMATION SILOS

by Left

CROSS-SCHOOL PROJECT COLLABORATION

VOLUNTEER ACTIVITIES

INTER-SCHOOL SPORTS COMPETITIONS

CLUB EXCHANGE

INTERNATIONAL CURRICULUM STUDENTS (IB/A-LEVEL/AP) ARE WORKING IN SILOS
— INFORMATION, RESOURCES, AND PARTNERS STAY WITHIN SMALL CIRCLES AND “熟人” NETWORKS.

11/10

THE PROBLEM

THREE QUESTIONS WE WANT TO ANSWER

Is this project worth doing?

If yes, which scenario should we tackle first among the four areas?

What format — community, info hub, or mini-program — avoids becoming just another dead group chat

ABOUT *the* RESEARCH

In-depth interviews — two types of users:

Community organizer: Founder of **Econmind,** a student-run non-profit site/community at Suzhou High School IB (苏州中学国际部)

Regular user: A-Level student at Ulink College(领科)

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FINDING 1

INFORMATION EXISTS, BUT NOT THE RIGHT INFORMATION

Evidence

Econmind founder:

"It was hard to find what fit me, so I built Econmind myself."

Existing channels don't cover everyone

Students need matched information, not more information

Self-built solutions signal real demand

FINDING 2

The Friction Is Coordination, Not Willingnes

Real friction points in cross-school competitions:

- No coordinated transportation
- Complicated school-entry and contact processes
- Referees, venues, and schedules require multi-party coordination
- Few acquaintances in other schools; everything falls on students

Interpretation:

- Students want to collaborate — organizational cost is too high
- What's missing is process and matching mechanisms

FINDING 3

Demand for "Order" Comes Mainly from Organizers

Organizer (Econmind):

No unorganized, unregulated group chats

No mega-groups — split into topic-based groups

Deadlines matter; capable management matters

Regular user (Ulink):

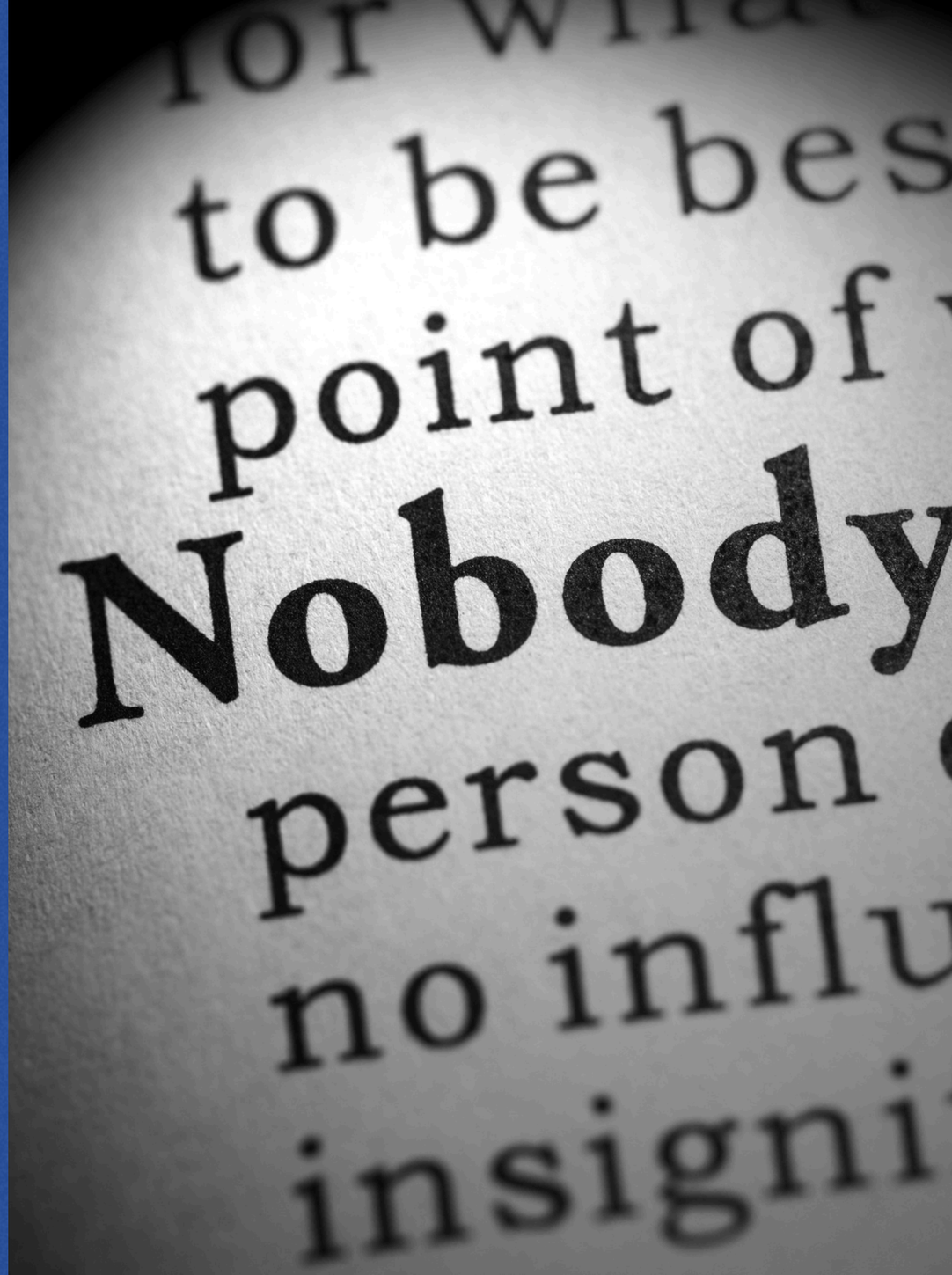
Not concerned about privacy, ads, or being ignored

Cares about: usable, countable, communicable

Interpretation:

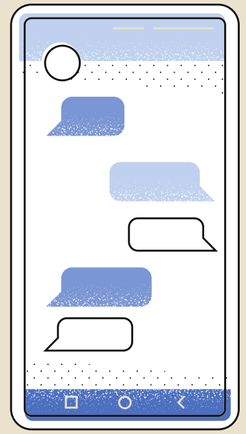
Order is an organizer's need; low barrier is a user's need

Design in layers: lightweight participation on the surface, management underneath



Dimension	Organizer (Econmind)	Regular User (Ulink)
Info channel	Self-built site/community	Offline peer network; department groups & clubs as supplements
Biggest pain	Can't find matching info; chaotic groups	Too few people know; travel & coordination cost
Format preference	Topic-based groups, forum, filing	WeChat groups + post-style publishing; WeChat over DingTalk
Core features	Filing, privacy verification, experience posts	Sign-up counting + comments
Risk sensitivity	High (fear of no management, no users)	Low (not worried about privacy/ads/being ignored)
View on "official sponsorship"	Capable management matters	Helps "students finding everything themselves," but doesn't solve time issues

RISKS & NEXT STEPS



Biggest risk is not technology — it's "**nobody cares.**"

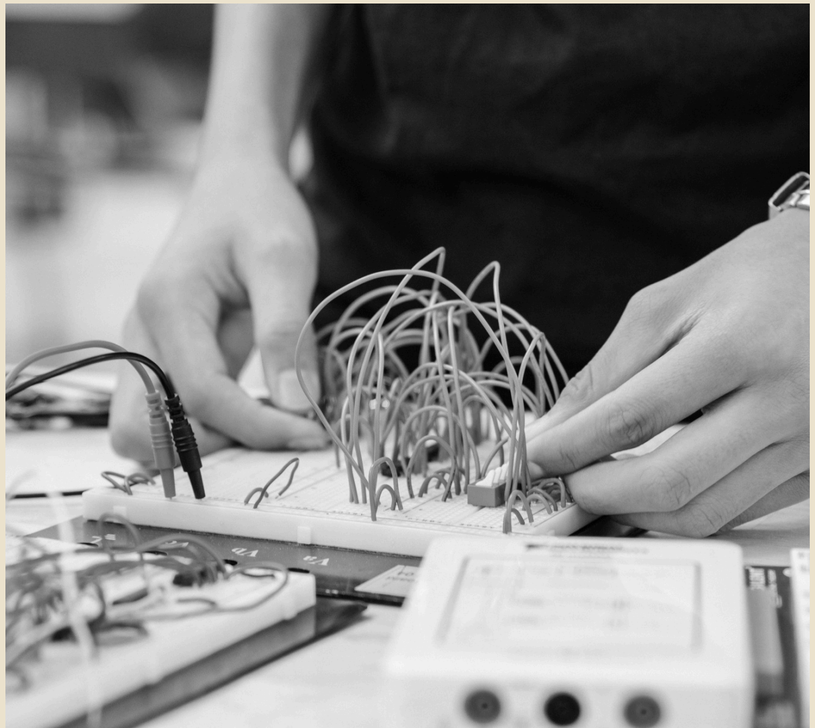
- Cold-start risk > technical risk
- Management-cost risk > feature-gap risk

Lightweight format

To create the basic structure of product(rule document)

To make sure At least 1 scenario runs the full loop:

post → sign-up → comment → team formed



THANK YOU